Sprint 3: User Interviews Report

Chris Lee, Jaimin Fee, Kurt Schimmel (Team 6)

WhosDown: Mobile app that makes pickup sports easier

1. Method

We tested the Figma click-through prototype (Section 6 of the main Sprint 3 document) with **4 participants** from our target users: people who play, or want to play, pickup sports around CMU. Each participant moved through the prototype on their own. We asked what they liked, what confused or bothered them, and what they wanted the app to do, and took notes during each session. For P3 and P4 we also wrote down what worked and what did not as they used specific screens. The full notes are in the Appendix.

Participant	Main focus of their feedback
P1	Social features, sport-specific profiles, trust in hosts and groups
P2	Groups, group chats, schedules, and community
P3	Saving favorites, reminders, sharing, friends attending, recommendations; on the screens: sport choices, distance input, organizer profile, what happens when a game ends or fills up, ratings
P4	Safety and trust when meeting strangers, host reputation, reporting; on the screens: layout and spacing, too many page changes, leaving a game, the approval process, status colors

2. What worked

Finding	Participants
Photos and media on games	P1
Clear information about who the host is helps safety and trust	P1, P2
Prices are shown clearly before joining	P1
Connecting with friends and seeing what activities they join	P1
Dedicated group profiles where members can learn about a group before joining	P2
Clean overall interface	P3
The map shows at a glance where nearby games are	P3, P4
Posting a game was easy	P3
Adding friends you meet through the app	P4
Private games for playing with people you already know	P4
Rating the people you play with	P4
Seeing the roster of who is playing	P4

3. Lessons learned

Each lesson lists who raised it, what we will change, and which release it goes into (feature numbers from Section 9 of the main document).

#	Lesson	Who	What we will change	When
1	Social connection is the strongest request	P1, P2, P3	Friends, friends activity, and messaging come first after V1	V2
2	Friends and mutual connections drive joining	P1, P2, P3	"Friends attending" on games; mutual friends on groups and profiles	V2
3	Safety matters when meeting strangers	P4, P1, P2	Clear host identity, approval joining, reporting (V1); reputation, blocking, hidden location	V1 + V2
4	Hosts need a track record	P4	Past Games and attended/hosted counts (V1); reviews and reliability (V2)	V1 + V2
5	Users need a way to report	P4	Safety & Reporting form moved into V1	V1
6	Reminders and alerts are expected	P3, P4	Local game reminder (V1); push and new-game alerts (V2)	V1 + V2
7	Groups need profiles and discovery	P1, P2	Group page with about, members, games; sport and skill filters	V2
8	Groups need visible schedules	P2	Recurring group events and calendar export	V1 + V2
9	Favorites save time	P3	Favorite sports (V1); pinned groups, favorite fields, saved games (V2)	V1 + V2
10	Games should be easy to share	P3	Share link and in-app invite	V2
11	Recommendations help discovery	P3	"Why these?" ranking from sports, level, distance, history	V2
12	Chats are hard to tell apart	P2	Label each chat with its group or game and sport	V2
13	Joining a new group feels awkward	P1, P2	Member profiles on the group page and a "say hi" prompt	V2
14	Profiles should be organized by sport	P1, P4	Profile section per sport with level (V1); profile media (V2)	V1 + V2
15	Keep prices visible before joining	P1	Keep price on Discover and Game Detail	V1
16	Organizer profile is hard to find	P3, P4	Whole organizer row tappable, labeled "View profile"	V1
17	Game life cycle is unclear	P3	Say games move to Past after they end; "Full · Join waitlist"	V1
18	Approval and leaving are unclear	P4	Explain the three approval steps; visible Leave / Cancel button	V1
19	Status needs color	P4	Green approved, amber pending, red declined, gray waitlisted	V1
20	Too many page changes, uneven spacing	P4	Bottom sheets for small steps; 8-point spacing pass	V1
21	Ratings need to explain themselves	P3, P4	Review screens say what each answer affects; keep comments	V2
22	More sports, typed distance, time filters	P3, P4	Nine sports plus custom; typed miles; custom time range	V1

#	Lesson	Who	What we will change	When
23	Requested features already in the design	P4	Keep guest login, play style, level per sport, post-game notes	V1 + V2

4. Summary

- Testers trust the app more when they know **who the host is, what the game costs, and who else is going**. Safety came up strongly (P4), so **reporting moves into V1** and host reputation stays a top V2 item.
- Testers expect the app to **remind them**. A local reminder before each approved game is **added to V1**, because it needs no server. Push alerts stay in V2.
- The biggest requests are **social and group features**: friends attending, mutual friends, group profiles with schedules, sharing, and favorites. They confirm our V2 plan and add six V2 items (2.18–2.23).
- Watching testers use the screens showed **clarity problems in the core loop**: the organizer profile was hard to find, testers did not understand approval, leaving, or what happens when a game fills up or ends, and statuses all looked alike. These fixes go into **V1** (lessons 16–20, 22), together with a layout pass (1.26).
- Testers liked the clean interface, the map, how easy it was to post a game, private games, and the roster. No tester asked to remove a feature, and the core loop (find, join, host) stays the same.

5. Changes to the Feature List

These findings changed the Version 1 / Version 2 plan in the main Sprint 3 document (Section 9):

- **Added to Version 1:** game reminders (1.24), reporting a user or game (1.25), and a layout and interaction pass with bottom sheets and consistent spacing (1.26).
- **Clarified in Version 1:** all nine sports plus a custom sport (1.4, 1.11); typed distance and a custom time range in filters (1.7); a tappable organizer row and a note that games move to Past Games (1.8); an explanation of the approval steps and one color per status (1.14); a visible Leave / Cancel button (1.16); "Full · Join waitlist" (1.17); color-coded My Games (1.19); a profile organized by sport (1.22).
- **Added to Version 2:** profile media (2.18), group schedules (2.19), labeled chats (2.20), hiding the exact location until approved (2.21), sharing a game or group (2.22), and saved games (2.23). Review screens now explain what each answer affects (2.6).

6. Limitations

- Four participants, all from our target group of pickup-sports players around CMU, so the results may not represent every kind of player.
- The prototype does not save data or accept typed input, so participants could not try real messaging, filtering by a typed value, or receiving notifications.

Appendix: Interview Notes

Interviewee 1 (P1)

- Wants profiles to be organized by sport, rather than having one general profile focused on soccer.
- Likes the media aspect of the app and wants more social features.
- Would like to add photos and other media to their profile to show their personality and interests.
- Wants more features to help people connect and introduce themselves when joining a new group or activity.
- Likes the idea of connecting with friends and seeing what activities they participate in.
- Would like to see mutual friends or shared connections to make joining activities feel more comfortable and reliable.
- Wants to discover groups based on shared interests, not just specific games.
- Likes having clear information about the host to improve safety and trust.
- Appreciates that game prices are clearly displayed before joining.

Interviewee 2 (P2)

- Wants group chats to be better organized, with clear labels showing which group, sport, or activity each chat belongs to.
- Likes the idea of dedicated group profiles where members can learn about the group before joining.
- Would like more ways to discover groups based on shared interests, skill levels, and preferred sports.
- Wants calendar integration or scheduling information for recurring group events and activities.
- Would like to see upcoming events and schedules directly on group profiles.
- Thinks mutual friends, shared connections, or other information about group members would help establish trust and reliability.
- Wants introductions to be easier when joining a new group, potentially through member profiles and group chats.
- Likes clear host identification so users know who is organizing an event.
- Would like stronger social features that make it easier to connect with other members and build a community beyond individual games.

Interviewee 3 (P3)

- Would like a way to pin favorite groups and events for quick access.
- Wants reminders for upcoming games and notifications when new games are posted for their preferred sports.
- Would like to share events with friends through a link or directly through the app.
- Wants to see which friends are attending a game before deciding whether to join.
- Would like recommendations for games based on preferred sports, skill level, location, and past participation.
- Wants to save favorite sports and locations to make discovering relevant games easier.

Interviewee 4 (P4)

- Is concerned about safety when joining games

- Would like users to have profiles with basic information, sports interests, and experience to help establish trust before meeting in person.
- Would like to see ratings or reviews of hosts based on previous events.
- Would like a way to report inappropriate behavior or suspicious events.
- Wants to receive notifications when a group they follow posts a new event.
- Would like to see a history of events attended/hosted

Key takeaways

- Users want more social features to connect with friends
- Users would like a way to discover groups based on shared interests and sports.
- Groups should have profiles with associated information (organized chats, about, recurring event schedules)
- Calendar integration could be helpful (gcal or device)
- Users want to save favorite groups and events
- Reminders and notifications are needed
- A share feature for events or groups is needed
- A recommendation system based on interests and skill levels could be useful for users
- Safety features such as hidden event locations, host approval, and user reporting could make joining unfamiliar games more comfortable

Interviewee 3 (P3): notes while using the screens

Positive

- Clean overall user interface
- Easy Map view for a sense of where nearby games are happening
- Posting a game was relatively easy

Negative

- Would like more options to add other sports of liking
- Would like to manually type in distance
- Want to click into the organizers for their profile info
- Not enough info on what happens after the event time(does the event disappear from the listing?)
- Unexpected type of information when more info on the games were clicked
- What happens when you go over the limit number of participants (would like enough detail on that)
- Would like functionality to get an alert when someone posts a game
- Unsure what the real effects are of rating others
- Would like a more qualitative review of other players

Features Wanted

- Ability to add and select from a wider range of sports.
- Custom distance input when searching for nearby games.
- Clickable organizer profiles with more information about the host.
- Clearer event details, including what happens after the event ends and when a game reaches its participant limit.
- Notification and rating system, including alerts for newly posted games and more qualitative player reviews.

Interviewee 4 (P4): notes while using the screens

Positive

- Easy access to nearby events
- The social feature being able to add friends you meet through the app
- Having a private feature to play with people you know already
- Having a rating system to review others you play with
- Being able to see the roster of people who play together

Negative

- Finds the spacing between some icons too wide and would like them placed closer together.
- Finds some of the framing and alignment inconsistent.
- Feels that screens switch too often and would prefer more information to appear through pop-ups rather than navigating to a new page.
- Does not think a separate page is necessary for some smaller interactions.
- Finds it unclear how to leave or cancel after a game has been reserved.
- Wants more information about how the reservation and approval process works.

Features Wanted

- Select a preferred play style when creating a profile.
- Stronger time filtering when searching for games.
- Write notes or comments after joining or attending a game.
- Ratings to include more individualized comments rather than relying only on a general score.
- Click on the organizer to view their profile and additional information.
- Some form of rank or player level displayed on profiles.
- Push notifications for important rating-related updates.
- Have a guest login option so new users can explore and test features before creating an account.
- Would like clearer visual feedback, such as different colors for approvals and denials.